

Pluralism and Postmodernism

From around 1970, art movements emerged and dissolved with increasing speed. Artists employed a broader range of materials, approaches and processes than ever before, including video, performance, computers and the internet, as well as traditional materials. Incorporating a variety of styles, ideas and cultural trends, with no dominant culture or country leading the way, Pluralism seemed to be the most appropriate way of describing it all.

Postmodernism is another umbrella term for art movements that sought to challenge aspects of Modernism. It is often seen as starting with Pop art's elimination of distinctions between high and mass culture, and its refusal to accept the authority of any one style or definition of what art should be. Postmodern art is often quirky, absurd, irreverent or meaningless. Postmodernists often work with new technologies, including television, video, smartphones, computers and the internet, sourcing, manipulating and processing imagery.



Centre Georges Pompidou, Paris, 1972–77